

BA FASHION DESIGN

Module	5FADE005W/2 - IDENTITY
Module Leader	Tumi Ladega / Hannah Rumball-Croft
Key Dates/Times	Briefing: Thursday 25 February 2027, 14:00 (online) Storyboard seminar: Tuesday 2 March 2027 3D workshop: Thursday 4 March 2027 Essay Unit sign-up tutorials: Tuesday 16 and Tuesday 23 March 2027 (Forum) Presentation: Thursday 8 April 2027, 14:00 Hand in: Thursday 15 April 2027 1pm Weeks of study: 7

Brief:

You will design from self-reflective research into the notion of identity. This may be an investigation of historical, current or potential future identity - personal or cultural - and the choice is yours to make and to defend.

You will undertake detailed research into the clothing and culture of your chosen concept. This may include cultural artefacts: objects, art, garments, textiles, technology. Emphasis is placed on researching and recording historical, contemporary and innovative methods of design, make and construction, in the context of equality, diversity and inclusion.

That research becomes the basis of design development, producing a variety of design outcomes and a 3D prototype. A range of illustrations and portfolio work follows from the design work and the final physical prototype. Alongside the practical work you will produce a theoretical piece of writing grounded in the same self-reflective research.

Working from Yourself

This module asks you to make yourself the subject of research, which is harder than it sounds and fails in a predictable way: personal significance is asserted rather than shown. A garment that means something to you means nothing to anyone else until you have made the case through evidence.

By the storyboard seminar on 2 March you must have:

- A stated position: whose identity, which moment, and why it warrants examination now
- Primary research - interviews, family archive, objects in your possession, places you can visit
- Secondary research that situates the personal in the historical or cultural
- An honest account of what you do not know and cannot access

Nostalgia is not research. Neither is a mood board.

Equality, Diversity and Inclusion

EDI is the analytical frame of this module, not a section to be appended. You are asked to record how methods of design, make and construction have included and excluded people, and to be specific about your own position in relation to the material you work with.

- Whose labour made the garments and textiles you are researching, and is that labour credited
- Where your chosen tradition sits in relation to whoever has historically been permitted to define taste
- Whether you are working from within a culture or looking at one, and what that changes about your claims
- How your design decisions include or exclude bodies, budgets and abilities

A project that cannot answer the third question honestly is not ready to be made.

Research Requirements

- Observational and analytical drawing from primary sources
- Photographic and written recording of artefacts, with provenance noted
- Museum, gallery and archive visits - the Westminster Menswear Archive and the V&A; study rooms are both available to you
- Library and academic sources; online sources alone are not sufficient, and this matters more here than usual given the essay
- Where you interview or photograph people, obtain and record their consent

Assessment:

Assessment name	Weighting %	Qualifying mark	%Assessment type
Portfolio	75%		Research, Design Development, Portfolio and 3D Prototype
Theoretical Writing	25%		Written submission, 2,000 words

Work to be submitted for Assessment:

PDF document (approx 32 pages), a separate written submission, and a physical prototype. File name format: Forename_Surname_Identity_2027_PDF

Part 1: Self-Reflective Research and Contextual Investigation (minimum 14 pages)

- Concept statement, one page, naming your position and its limits
- Primary research: drawing, photography, recorded conversation, collected artefacts
- Contextual and historical research situating the personal material
- EDI analysis as set out above, evidenced rather than asserted
- Colour, material and silhouette direction drawn from the research

Part 2: Design Development (10 pages)

- Iterative design development showing decisions and rejections, not only outcomes
- Capsule collection: fully rendered line-up of 6 outfits, front and back views
- Black and white technical drawing of the final garment, front and back, on Illustrator
- Storyboard as developed for the 2 March seminar, revised

Part 3: 3D Prototype (6 pages)

- One physical prototype realising the final design
- Evidence of toiling and fitting, including what changed and why
- Photographed on a stand: front, back and side; and photographed on a model
- Detail photographs of construction and finish

Part 4: Theoretical Writing (2,000 words, submitted separately)

- A theoretical piece grounded in your self-reflective research - not a project diary and not a description of what you made
- An argument with a position, evidence and acknowledged counter-position
- Harvard referencing throughout, with a full bibliography
- Word count declared on the title page; the bibliography is excluded from it

- Sign-up tutorials for this are offered on 16 and 23 March - bring a draft or an outline, not a blank page

Physical Submission

- Prototype with name and group number stitched inside the back neck

Presentation

The presentation on 8 April is to the whole cohort. Ten minutes plus questions. Present your position, the research that supports it, and the prototype. Be prepared to be asked whose story you are telling and on what authority - that is the question this module exists to make you able to answer.